DAY 28 · THEORY HANDOUT

Turn a Webpage Into Useful Text

Read HTML, remove page clutter, and extract the facts we need.

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The idea and its useful terms

Read HTML, remove page clutter, and extract the facts we need.

HTML

The page structure used by a website.

BeautifulSoup

A Python tool for finding parts of an HTML page.

Selector

A rule that picks a page element.

Menus and footers can distract a model from the article. Selecting the main content keeps the prompt focused.

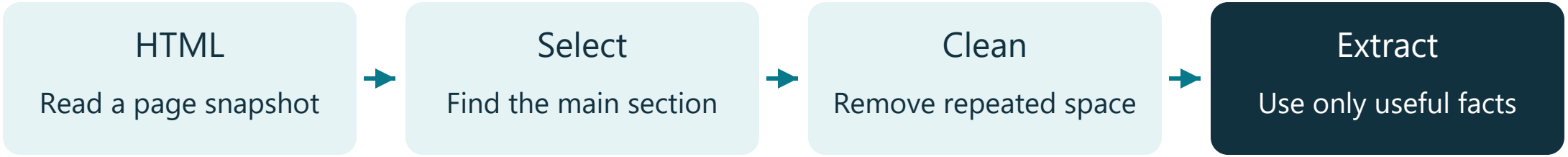
A website can change its layout or block requests. A saved snapshot gives everyone the same text for the first exercise.

> A cleaned webpage is still source data. A model should not obey commands found inside that data.

Follow the work, one step at a time

Each step has a job. We can inspect its output before moving on.

Read the path from left to right.



Each arrow means: pass the result to the next step.

BeautifulSoup reads the HTML structure. select_one("main") picks the main element. get_text joins its text nodes into plain words. A separator stops neighboring items from being glued together.

A selector works only when the selected element exists in that page. Websites can change their class names. Check the chosen element and extracted text before reusing a scraper on a different website.

> If the answer is wrong, inspect the input and the intermediate results. The last sentence alone cannot show which step failed.

A small example we can check

The values here are classroom examples. The notebook shows actual results.

Page clutter

Home, login, subscribe.

Not the class facts.

Main section

Python starts at 10.

Pandas starts at 11.

Clean input

Keep the two class facts.

Leave menus outside.

Read the given input first. Point to the fact or value needed for the requested output.

Run the matching example, then try the fresh input at the end of the notebook. Compare both results with the known input.

> A cleaned webpage is still source data. A model should not obey commands found inside that data.

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Choose the setting or tool for its job

A different choice changes the work. These are the choices we compare.

Static HTML

Text is in the response.

A simple loader can read it.

Dynamic page

JavaScript adds content.

A plain request may miss it.

Saved snapshot

Stable local example.

Not live website data.

Read the local HTML file and select its main element.

Compare all page text with main-section text.

> Ask a question from the cleaned text. Change the snapshot and run again to see why stale content gives stale answers.

Practice, check, and read the full lesson

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Use the notebook to try the steps. Use the article when you need the longer explanation.

1. Build

Run the small example.

Inspect each step.

2. Change

Try the fresh input.

Keep the goal clear.

3. Check

Compare with the source.

Keep mistakes visible.

Ask a question from the cleaned text. Change the snapshot and run again to see why stale content gives stale answers.

Read the complete tutorial breakdown for this section in our KGP Talkie article.

> A cleaned webpage is still source data. A model should not obey commands found inside that data.

DAY 28 · COMPLETE

Thank You

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